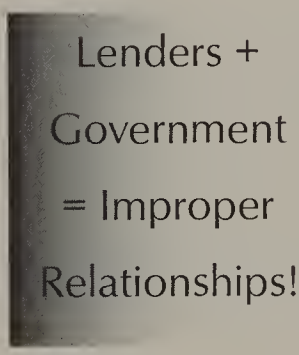


federal government. His position? General manager of federal student aid! When the allegations came to light, he was put on administrative leave, which means he still received his paycheck. The April 2007 News Blog of the *Chronicle of Higher Education* stated that this discovery was just one more incident in “a series of ‘disturbing findings of improper relationships’ between lenders in the federal guaranteed-student-loan program and the government officials charged with overseeing them.” Amen to that.

In a press release issued by one senator addressing the situation, it states, “We need to ensure that those charged with administering federal student loan programs put the interests of students first. It is inexcusable for students to be paying the price for backroom deals in the student loan industry.”



Lenders +
Government
= Improper
Relationships!

We all are paying for these types of backroom deals between the consumer lending industry and the federal government. And it is inexcusable. It's beyond inexcusable. There has been a serious breach of trust. Moral code seems to have vanished. If we cannot have faith in our government and our big business bankers, who can we have faith in? Ourselves.

We can learn how to circumvent the problems when we know what they are up to. The best defense is a good offense. We can learn how they play the game so we can beat them at it.

These are all examples of the enormous problem of greed in our country. Many colleges and universities have a required ethics course, but obviously it was not part of the graduation credits when the current bank executives and people in high financial places were in school. Maybe they just forgot what they were taught; or perhaps the golden rule of “treat others as you would like to be treated” was not part of the curriculum in their kindergarten class. There is a basic element in our society that we need to get back, a sense of honor and a backbone of integrity. We need to teach future generations that human beings can succeed without greed. Striving for wealth and stability is not the same as indecency and gluttony.

And while we work toward that, we will fight back.